



Purnima: Challenge Fund to ensure Leave No One Behind

The devastating earthquake of 2015 cost thousands of lives and damaged infrastructure and livelihood in Nepal. As part of the recovery effort, Mott MacDonald has been managing the UK aid support to the Government of Nepal for building back better and supporting the recovery of livelihoods. The Purnima Programme covers four of the most affected districts of Gorkha, Dhading, Nuwakot and Rasuwa through four components: strengthening local government, direct reconstruction of the rural infrastructure, private sector development, and Challenge Fund (CF) to ensure leave no one behind in the reconstruction and recovery processes.

Purnima's Challenge Fund supports vulnerable people who were affected by the 2015 earthquakes and have not yet been able to rebuild their houses and livelihoods, or to access services related to reconstruction and recovery. Although most people have now rebuilt their houses, there are still many extremely vulnerable people – especially single women, disabled, elderly living on their own, those displaced from their communities (IDPs), and the extremely poor – who are badly struggling.

The Purnima CF targets these most vulnerable people, to leave no one behind (LNOB), providing support for economic and livelihood recovery, social empowerment and wellbeing, and technical assistance for housing reconstruction. Besides, the direct need-based support to vulnerable people for their recovery, the CF partners CDC Nepal, DanChurchAid, SAAPROS Nepal and PHASE Nepal works in coordination with local government for change in local institutions, systems and policies so that vulnerable groups are able to access their rights to services and support. The fund aims to reach 55,000 beneficiaries directly during the project and to support local government to ensure that these benefits are sustained and extended to other vulnerable people.

The four pillars that guide the Challenge Fund are:

Understanding Vulnerability for Action: Purnima conducted studies to identify and better understand vulnerability in different gaupalikas of four districts. This helped to deepen the understanding of vulnerability, including status of housing/reconstruction by vulnerable households and the specific barriers to recovery. It also helped to understand the existing coping strategies, explore the access of vulnerable groups to recovery and reconstruction services, and propose practical solutions to address the challenges, which guided the various efforts of the fund.

Social Empowerment: Purnima also supports vulnerable and excluded individuals to access the government entitlements and social services by working closely with the local governments. Activities

under the social component include support to vulnerable people to access services such as vulnerable identity card, timely distribution of social benefits through social security distribution camps, and assistive devices to people with disabilities, and strengthening vulnerable people's local institutions and groups for collective voice for services and benefits.

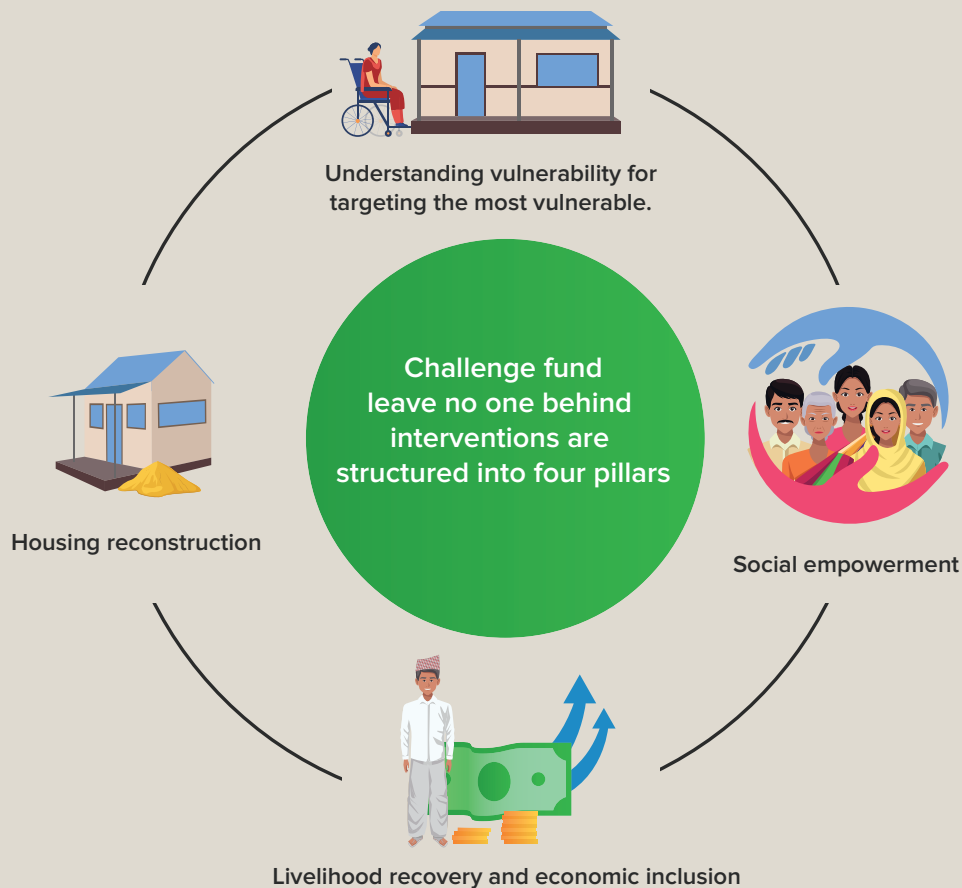
Livelihood Recovery and Economic Inclusion: Purnima supports targeted vulnerable people to increase their income, skills, and other livelihood and economic opportunities. Support under the economic component include assistance to vulnerable people to diversify and increase income and livelihood opportunities thorough on-farm, off-farm activities and skills-based income generating activities (IGAs). The project also supports with knowledge, skills and technology transfer for sustainable income recovery of the vulnerable people. It collaborates with local government for conducive policy environment to achieve sustainability and longer-term economic inclusion objective.

Housing Reconstruction and Recovery Support: Purnima provides socio-technical assistance and facilitation to vulnerable households to access the National Reconstruction Authority's housing reconstruction grants and services. For ensuring access to housing support grants, Purnima helped organizing dialogues with gaunpalikas and provided orientation to the vulnerable households on the process of registering grievances. It has also been providing in-kind support for reconstruction of houses which is tailored to the needs of individual vulnerable households.

Purnima's COVID-19 response and recovery

As a post-disaster programme, Purnima was well placed to pivot quickly to initiate new pandemic relief activities while continuing existing earthquake-recovery ones. Purnima works closely with local governments in 12 palikas to provide relief and recovery support for those most in need and plan longer-term support if it is required. It supports livelihood and income activities for the most vulnerable groups, including new vulnerable groups affected by COVID-19 to cope up with the impact of COVID-19 on them. Additionally, health and hygiene messages are communicated for raising awareness among communities of additional care and safeguarding requirements for vulnerable groups.

Key approaches



Key achievements (as of October 2021)



Social

12,732 vulnerable community members accessed social benefits and services from Palika



Economic

20,385 vulnerable community members supported through livelihood and income recovery activities



Housing

7,452 vulnerable community members supported with housing reconstruction

Purnima's COVID-19 response and recovery:

7,228 vulnerable community members were facilitated to access COVID-19 relief and response packages from local government.



Household relief package from the local government



Key health message on COVID-19 awareness on prevention and protection



Orientation on proper handwashing techniques, social distancing and use of mask



Beside ensuring relief support from Palikas, 16,049 vulnerable individuals were supported for economic and livelihood recovery directly through project.

For more information :

Kiran Wagle, Team Leader at kiran.wagle@mottmac.com

Website: www.purnimanepal.com